

This past Saturday I woke up at an early hour and headed north to meet up with another Sierra Club group to do a hike up Mt. Baden Powell. It is one of the higher peaks up in the San Gabriel mountains besides Mt. Baldy and tops out at 9,399 ft. We'd only have to gain about 2800 of those feet.

Less pictures on this one just due to the circumstances of the hike. My camera was a bit too bulky with all the water in my daypack so I only have what I could beg from others.

We were actually quite fortunate because after leaving the 15 we saw signs all over the place saying the road to Vincent Gap was closed. Due to this being a dry year more and more areas are closing now that we're getting into the summer. We ignored the signs and pressed on to find that the trailhead at Vincent Gap was literally the last thing before the road was closed.



After a 4 mile series of switchbacks this is the reward. This is the ridgeline you cross to reach the peak proper though this is of the view coming back from the peak. Though you can't see it to the right of this picture is a drop that goes down several thousand feet rather abruptly. To the left there is a drop that is only somewhat less steep.



This would be the drop to the right.





And here is the motley crew that decided to spend their Saturday morning hiking up a mountain. The view up here (not pictured sadly enough) was amazing. We were looking across a canyon on Mt Baldy to one direction, in another you could see the south Sierras way off in the distance, and you could even make out the peak of Mt. Saddleback back towards where I live. The white patch barely visible in the distance above the group is actually Edwards Air Force Base.

The hike down was punishing on the knees but went fairly quickly and then I was off to a beach bonfire with another Sierra Club group where we froze our butts off in the wind.

Next weekend: Mt. Baldy!